HUSH! CAUTION! ECHOLAND!

Roger Alsop
School of Production
Faculty of the VCA and MCM
University of Melbourne

ABSTRACT

Hush! Caution! Echoland! is part of a series of works entitled "Sounding Finnegan's Wake". In this series computer/algorithmically generated instrumental, acousmatic, interactive, and audio/visual pieces are being developed, based on the sound and structure of Finnegan's Wake . The premise informing these works is that Finnegan's Wake can be understood as a textual work and as sound art. In Joyce's writing these two approaches are complementary, each informing and influencing each other. Hush! Caution! Echoland! takes chapter one of Finnegan's Wake as its material, from which to create a score for traditional instruments and electronics. The instrumental part is derived from the structure of the text as expressed initially through its ASCII representation. This is then deconstructed through a number of processes to form the score for Flute, Clarinet, Violin, Viola and Cello. The electronic part also uses the ASCII representation of the text and spatializes the instrument sounds according to that structure. This is done through use of synthetic reverberation and panning techniques. Processes for using text to generate music have been explored by many, including the author, and the outcomes are varied. These processes range through an aesthetics based text setting, such as the writing of a pop song or liturgical music where the compose a response to what they they think complements the text or and answers the intentions of the author. Other approaches, such as using the inherent sounds of the text are comparatively rarer. Brunson's [1] discussion of processes is comprehensive, and Eberhard Blum's [2] renditions of Cage's Mesostics re Merce Cunningham and Amanda Stewart and Chris Mann's [3] works are indicators of taking text from the descriptive realm to the less descriptive realm of sound art are examples. Processes for using text as a system for musical creation that is not designed to represent the meaning of the text are even rarer, the author has explored this [4-8], and this project is a continuation of these explorations. Work by others in the area is varied across a wide field ranging through exemplars ad processes [9- 15]. Details of the processes use will be discussed in the accompanying 'Piece and Paper'

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